

then controllers have been given a good preference over the keyboard and mouse combination. Games these days are not that easy to tell if they are console ports but nevertheless let's have a look at what all controllers we can get our hands on.

Types

In order to give players a more rich experience game controllers were designed to mimic the environment in which the gamers would be within the virtual world, so we have joysticks, steering wheels, gamepads, motion sensors and even cockpits. We'll focus on the more commonly available ones here.

Joystick

The joystick is what you'd like to use for aircraft and space simulators. There are plenty of buttons on most joysticks so you can do away with the keyboard and mouse altogether and play the entire game using just the joystick. Joysticks tend to come in two common variants these days, the 4-axis and the 6-axis. The axis refers to the degree of freedom a joystick has. Technically, they are referred to as pitch, yaw and roll and can be envisioned as the image below. A 4-axis controller is a more accurate depiction since in airplanes the yaw (or simply turning left / right) is controlled via pedals and you can get a good joystick with pedals as an accompaniment. So a 4-axis controller means the controller stick moves back and forth, and then moves left and right. Adding the ability to rotate

the stick to the left and to the right adds two more degrees of freedom and makes it a 6-axis controller. A few buttons are placed on the joystick where the thumb comes to rest, these are generally for triggering weapons. So you can imagine that the experience of using a joystick simply is unparalleled to that of a keyboard.



Steering wheels

Playing a racing game on a keyboard and on a steering wheel feel miles apart. That's just not it, a good set of